

GAUNTLET

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

Version 0.6.1 — First Playtest Revision



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Welcome to Gauntlet

Gauntlet is a two-player tactical card-and-territory game. Each player builds a Deck, chooses one of six factions and one of that faction's Leaders, and contributes three Territories to a shared six-Territory battlefield called the **Gauntlet**.

Players advance toward one another, fight battles, occupy and capture opposing Territories, develop Assets, and pursue faction-specific plans. The normal way to win is to cross the entire battlefield, capture the opponent's final Territory, force a Last Stand beyond the Gauntlet, and win that battle.

This rulebook is written in two layers. Each major section begins with **How it works**, which teaches the ordinary rule in clear language. **Complete rules** follows with exact timing, exceptions, and edge cases. The two layers are parts of the same rulebook and do not contradict one another.

Rules Conventions

How it works

Follow the instructions on cards and components. When a specific rule conflicts with a general rule, the specific rule wins. Do as much of an instruction as possible unless the missing part is a required cost, requirement, or target.

Complete rules

- **May** indicates an optional effect. **Must** indicates a required effect.
- Resolve instructions in the order written unless another rule establishes a different order.
- When a card, Leader, faction, Territory, or supplemental-component rule conflicts with a general rule, follow the specific rule.
- Card text changes a card's normal destination only to the extent stated.
- If an instruction cannot be completed in full, complete as much as possible unless the uncompleted instruction is a required cost, requirement, or target.
- An effect resolves only at its stated timing. Revealing a card early does not cause a later portion of its effect to resolve early.
- An effect cannot be canceled or negated after it has resolved.

Playing cards

A card may have several printed effects. The way the card enters play determines which effect is used.

- **Action:** play during an Action Opportunity.
- **Gambit:** set only as a Gambit.
- **Tactic:** choose only as a Tactic.
- **Battle:** use as either a Gambit or Tactic.
- **Mission:** use only as instructed by Intelligence rules.

Faction guides and individual cards may define additional printed headings, such as **Terms**, **Asset**, **Overlay**, **Loan**, or **Effect**. Those headings use the timing and procedure stated by their governing text. They do not make a card eligible as a Gambit or Tactic unless the card also has an eligible Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect.

Playing a card for one printed effect does not activate its other printed effects unless a rule says otherwise.

Setting a Gambit or choosing a Tactic places the card in battle. It does not resolve immediately unless stated. A face-up Gambit or Tactic still waits for its normal reveal timing unless an effect says otherwise.

1. Components

How it works

Each player brings one complete Deck, one Player Token, and a six-sided die. A Deck contains a faction, one Leader, a Playable Deck of cards, three Territories, and any faction-specific components.

The players place their three Territories together to form the six-position battlefield.

Complete rules

Each player needs:

- one **Deck**;
- one **Player Token**; and
- one six-sided die.

The players may share a die.

A **Deck** consists of:

- one **Faction**;
- one **Leader Card**;
- one **Playable Deck**;
- three different **Territory Cards**; and
- any required faction- or Leader-specific supplemental cards or components.

Supplemental cards, reference cards, trackers, Deeds, Proposals, Rites, and similar components are part of the Deck but are not part of the Playable Deck unless a rule explicitly says otherwise. Missions and Special Operations are eligible cards from the Intelligence player's Playable Deck, not supplemental cards.

Together, both players' Territory Cards form the **Gauntlet**, a single six-Territory column.

Faction supplemental cards and trackers

Faction supplemental components keep each faction's public resources, progress, choices, and special procedures visible. Place them beside the Leader before play begins. They are game aids and state records, not cards that can normally be drawn or played.

Reference cards summarize the faction's procedures. Trackers record changing public values. Double-sided cards record whether a Proposal or Rite has changed state. Other components, such as Deeds and the Capital Ledger, remain on the table as instructed by their faction rules.

General use

- Keep every supplemental component face up and visible unless its own rules say otherwise.
- Begin each tracker at the faction's stated starting value and update it immediately whenever that value changes.

For a sliding tracker, place the indicated Leader or Reference Card over the tracker. Fully cover the tracker at 0, then slide the covering card until its bottom edge aligns with the current value.

- A counter, dial, written record, or other substitute may be used when it shows the same public information clearly and unambiguously.
- A reference card is a reminder, not a separate rules authority. If its shortened text omits a detail, follow this rulebook and the definitive faction guide.
- A double-sided supplemental card changes state only when its governing rule tells you to flip it. Keep any attached or bound cards with it so both players can identify the relationship.
- Supplemental components have no deckbuilding value and are not eligible as Gambits, Tactics, costs, collateral, Transmutation cards, Treasury cards, or other playable cards unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.
- Each player supplies and controls their own faction package unless a faction rule identifies a shared supply. In a mirror match, keep the two players' components separated and oriented toward their owners.

Military package

Use the selected Leader Card and the **Command Tracker**. Begin at 0 Command with the tracker fully covered by the Leader. Slide the Leader to 1 or 2 whenever Command changes. The Leader Card lists that Leader's three Orders; spend Command only at an Order's stated timing.

Diplomat package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Influence Tracker**, double-sided **Diplomat Reference Card**, and nine double-sided **Proposal /Treaty Article cards**. Begin at 1 Influence and place every Proposal with its Proposal side up. Lower the tracker when Influence is staked or spent and raise it when Influence returns or is gained. Flip an unratified Proposal to its Treaty Article side only when it is ratified. Leave ratified Articles face up so progress toward the Peace Treaty is public.

Financier package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Financier Reference Card**, public **Capital Ledger**, and eight identical **Deed Cards** in a shared supply. Begin with 0 Capital and an empty Treasury. Record every Capital gain, spend, loss, and end-turn reduction as a new Ledger transaction with a running Balance. When a Deed is bought, place one Deed Card beside its Territory on the owner's side; move it during a buyout and return it to the supply if it becomes unowned. A Deed is not an Asset or Overlay.

Intelligence package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Mission Reference Card**, **Operations Reference Card**, **Intel Tracker**, and **Operation Progress Tracker**. Both tracked values begin at 0 and have no maximum. Place the Intel Tracker beneath the Operations Reference and the Operation Progress Tracker beneath the Mission Reference, then slide the covering card to the current value. Record values beyond the printed track separately. An Active Mission or Special Operation is an eligible card from the Playable Deck placed face down near the Leader; the reference cards themselves never become Missions.

Mystics package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Mystics Reference Card**, and the three double-sided **Rite cards**: Rite of Echoes, Rite of Blood, and Rite of Crossing. Begin with every Rite incomplete-side up. Keep a begun Rite and any cards bound to it together. Flip the Rite when it is completed; reset it to the incomplete side when

its rules say it is interrupted. After all three are complete, keep the three cards bound to the Ritual of Ascendance together in a clearly marked area near the Leader. Mystics use no resource tracker.

Inquisition package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Inquisition Doctrine Reference Card**, **Purge Reference Card**, and **Conviction Tracker**. Begin at 0 Conviction with the tracker fully covered by the Leader. Slide the Leader to show the current value, to a maximum of 4. Use the Doctrine Reference to remember Condemnation, Blasphemy, and Purification; use the Purge Reference to choose and pay for a Purge.

2. Building a Deck

How it works

Choose one faction and one of its two Leaders. Build a Playable Deck of at least 30 cards with no more than 60 total deckbuilding value. Use Neutral cards and cards from your chosen faction. Then choose three different Territories.

Complete rules

Choose a faction and Leader

Choose one faction, then choose one Leader belonging to that faction. Both players may choose the same faction or Leader.

The Leader Card begins face up and remains available throughout the game.

Build the Playable Deck

A Playable Deck must contain:

- at least **30 cards**;
- no more than **60 total deckbuilding value**; and
- only Neutral cards and cards belonging to the selected faction.

Unless marked **Unique**, a card may appear in any quantity permitted by the available card pool. A Unique card is limited to one copy in the Playable Deck.

Choose Territories

Choose exactly three different Territory Cards.

- No more than one may be an **Arena**.
- Territory Cards are not part of the Playable Deck.
- Territories do not count toward the 30-card minimum or 60-value maximum.
- Both players may choose the same Territory titles.

Supplemental components

Prepare all components required by the chosen faction and Leader.

Unless a rule says otherwise, supplemental components:

- are not part of the Playable Deck;
- are not shuffled into the Draw Pile;
- cannot be drawn, played, discarded, banked, or placed in the Graveyard; and
- do not count toward deck size or deckbuilding value.

3. Setup

How it works

Shuffle your Playable Deck, arrange your three Territories secretly, then join them to your opponent's three Territories. Reveal the full Gauntlet, place your token just before your end, draw three cards, and roll to see who goes first.

Keep your permanent Hand, temporary battle cards, discard pile, Graveyard, Assets, and faction components in clearly separate areas.

Complete rules

Prepare the game in this order:

1. **Prepare the Draw Pile.** Shuffle the Playable Deck and place it face down. Leave room for the Discard Pile and Graveyard.
2. **Arrange Territories.** Secretly arrange the three Territory Cards in a line facing their owner.
3. **Form the Gauntlet.** Join both Territory lines to create one six-Territory column.
4. **Reveal Territories.** Reveal all six simultaneously. They remain face up unless an effect says otherwise.
5. **Prepare faction components.** Place Leaders, trackers, references, and supplemental components according to their rules.
6. **Place Player Tokens.** Place each token immediately before the Territory at that player's end.
7. **Draw opening Hands.** Each player draws three cards.
8. **Determine first player.** Each player rolls one die. Higher result goes first; reroll ties.

Recommended play areas

Each player should maintain distinct areas for:

- Draw Pile;
- Discard Pile;
- Graveyard;
- Hand;
- Asset Bank;
- Leader and supplemental components;
- Reserve;
- Gambit; and
- Tactic.

Cards in different zones must remain visibly separate even when space is limited.

4. Turn Structure

How it works

On your turn, first capture an opposing Territory you held through the opponent's turn. Then draw a card. You may take one Action either before or after movement. During movement, advance, hold, or withdraw. Resolve any battle immediately. Finally, discard down to three cards.

A battle ends the movement that started it. You move again afterward only when a rule or card specifically permits it.

Complete rules

Complete each turn in this order:

1. **Capture**
2. **Draw**
3. **Action Opportunity before movement**
4. **Movement**
5. **Action Opportunity after movement**
6. **Cleanup**

Capture

At the start of the turn, if the active player occupies a Territory they do not control, they capture it by rotating the Territory to face them.

Resolve effects and victory checks that occur after the Capture step before drawing.

Draw

Draw one card.

If the Draw Pile cannot complete a draw, shuffle the Discard Pile to form a new Draw Pile and continue. If the Draw Pile and Discard Pile cannot provide the full draw, draw as many cards as possible. Cards already drawn during that draw are not shuffled back.

Action Opportunities

The active player has one normal Action Opportunity each turn. It may be used before movement or, if unused, after movement.

During an Action Opportunity, the player may:

- play one card for its Action effect; or
- perform one rule or faction action that explicitly uses an Action Opportunity.

An additional Action Opportunity permits one additional qualifying action at the stated timing. It does not grant movement unless stated.

Movement

Advance, hold, or withdraw. Resolve any battle caused by movement immediately. When movement begins a battle, that movement ends and all unused movement is lost.

Cleanup

Resolve end-of-turn effects. If the active player has more than three cards in Hand, they discard until they have three. The turn ends.

5. Movement

How it works

During movement, you may move one position toward the opponent, remain where you are, or move one position toward your own end. Entering the opponent's position starts a battle.

A battle stops the current movement. Winning does not automatically let you continue moving; follow-up movement must come from an Order, card, or other specific effect.

Complete rules

A **position** is any location a Player Token may occupy:

- each Territory;
- the position immediately before either end of the Gauntlet; and
- the position immediately beyond either end.

During the Movement step, choose one:

- **Advance:** move one position toward the opponent's end.
- **Hold:** remain in the current position.
- **Withdraw:** move one position toward your own end.

A player cannot voluntarily withdraw beyond their own end. Player Tokens cannot move through or past one another.

If an effect grants additional movement, resolve it one position at a time unless stated otherwise. Entering an occupied position begins a battle. When that happens, the current movement sequence ends and any remaining movement is lost.

Entering an occupied Territory

Move the attacking token into the contested Territory before the battle. During the unresolved battle, the defender remains the occupant. If the attacker wins, the defender retreats and the attacker becomes the occupant.

Movement after battle

A player moves after a battle only when a rule or effect explicitly permits it. That movement is a new movement sequence and may start a new battle if the effect allows it.

6. Battles

How it works

A battle begins when one player enters the other's position. The moving player is the attacker and the other player is the defender.

First resolve effects that happen as the battle opens. Each player may then set one card from their Hand as a **Gambit**. Gambits are costly because they normally go to the Graveyard afterward.

Next, each player sets their Hand aside and draws three temporary cards to form a **Reserve**. Reveal Gambits, then each player may choose one Reserve card as a **Tactic**. Reveal Tactics, resolve the card effects, and roll dice. The higher battle total wins. If the totals are tied while the defender controls the contested Territory, Defender's Advantage means the defender wins the tie. Defender's Advantage is a tie rule, not the ordinary advantage mechanic that changes how dice are rolled.

Complete rules

The player whose movement or effect starts the battle is the **attacker**. The other player is the **defender**. Those roles remain fixed through the Aftermath of the battle.

Resolve each battle in this order:

1. Resolve opening effects.
2. Set Gambits.
3. Set Hands aside and form Reserves.
4. Reveal Gambits.
5. Choose Tactics.
6. Reveal Tactics.
7. Resolve the battle.
8. Resolve the Aftermath of the battle.

1. Opening effects

Establish the attacker, defender, and contested position. Resolve effects that occur when a battle would begin, when a battle opens, or before Gambits are set.

A mechanic such as Terms may prevent the pending battle. If no battle is fought, battle, victory, loss, and Aftermath triggers do not occur.

2. Set Gambits

Unless an effect changes the order:

1. the attacker sets up to one eligible Gambit face down or passes;
2. the defender sets up to one eligible Gambit face down or passes.

A card with a **Gambit** or **Battle** effect is eligible. Setting a Gambit is optional.

3. Form Reserves

Each player sets their Hand physically aside, then draws three cards to form a **Reserve**.

- The set-aside cards remain in Hand.
- A player may inspect and arrange their own Reserve freely.
- The Reserve is hidden from the opponent and separate from the Hand.
- Effects may modify the number of cards drawn.

4. Reveal Gambits

Reveal all Gambits simultaneously.

Effects that expressly resolve before other Gambit effects resolve first. After that, resolve remaining Gambit effects using the shared-timing rule below.

A face-up Gambit that was revealed early remains in battle and resolves at this stage unless its text says otherwise.

5. Choose Tactics

Unless an effect changes the order:

1. the attacker chooses up to one eligible Tactic from Reserve face down or passes;
2. the defender chooses up to one eligible Tactic from Reserve face down or passes.

A card with a **Tactic** or **Battle** effect is eligible.

6. Reveal Tactics

Reveal all Tactics simultaneously. Resolve their effects using the shared-timing rule.

A face-up Tactic revealed early remains in battle and waits for this stage unless its text says otherwise.

7. Resolve the battle

Resolve all effects that occur before dice are rolled. Then each player normally rolls one six-sided die.

Advantage and disadvantage

Combine all instances of advantage and disadvantage. They cancel one-for-one.

- For each net advantage, roll one additional die and use the highest result.
- For each net disadvantage, roll one additional die and use the lowest result.

After selecting the die result, resolve rerolls and changes to the die result in their specified order. Then apply numerical modifiers to determine the battle total.

Determine the winner

The higher battle total wins.

Defender's Advantage: This is a tie rule, not an instance of the ordinary advantage mechanic. If battle totals are tied and the defender controls the contested Territory, the defender wins. Defender's Advantage does not grant an additional die. It also applies during a Last Stand battle, so the defender wins tied Last Stand battle totals even though no Territory is contested there.

If a tie is not resolved by Defender's Advantage or another effect, both players reroll. Cards and effects already in use remain active.

Shared-timing rule

When multiple controlled effects resolve at the same time:

1. the attacker resolves one effect they control;
2. the defender resolves one effect they control;
3. continue alternating until no effects remain at that timing.

Each player chooses the order of effects they control. Simultaneous reveal does not mean simultaneous resolution.

Multiple and additional Gambits or Tactics

An effect may allow a player to set or choose more than the normal limit. Unless stated otherwise, that permission is optional.

When a player may choose more than one Tactic, they choose all of them simultaneously. Each remains a separate Tactic.

When an effect permits an **additional Tactic** after the normal choice:

- the card must have an eligible Tactic or Battle effect;
- if Tactics are already revealed, play it face up;
- resolve only effects whose timing remains available;
- do not reopen Tactic choices, reveal timing, Surveillance, or Interference; and
- follow the normal Tactic destination unless stated otherwise.

Replacements and revisions

A replacement takes the same role as the card it replaces.

- A replacement Gambit must be Gambit-eligible.
- A replacement Tactic must be Tactic-eligible.
- Place it in the face state instructed by the replacing effect.
- Replacement does not reopen an earlier timing window.
- Only unresolved effects whose timing remains available can resolve.

When an effect lets a player revise a choice, the revised choice does not create another reveal, Surveillance, Interference, or replacement opportunity unless stated otherwise.

Reveal and information

To reveal a face-down card, turn it face up and leave it face up.

To reveal a Hand or Reserve, its owner shows the entire zone to the opponent. The cards remain in that zone.

Negation

A negated card has no effect but remains in battle and keeps its role and normal destination unless stated otherwise.

An effect cannot be negated after it resolves.

Copied effects

When instructed to resolve another card's printed effect:

- resolve only the specified effect;
- treat **you** and **your** as the player resolving it;
- treat **this card** as the card whose text is being resolved;
- pay all costs and satisfy all requirements, targets, and timing restrictions;
- do not move the source card unless instructed;
- do not reopen an earlier timing window; and
- do not choose another effect that itself resolves another effect unless expressly allowed.

7. The Aftermath of the Battle

How it works

After the dice determine a winner, resolve the consequences of the battle. The loser retreats, the winner takes or keeps the contested position, and any additional retreat or capture effects occur. Then battle cards go to their normal destinations.

Gambits go to the Graveyard. Tactics and cards left in Reserve go to the Discard Pile. Remember: **Gambits go to the Graveyard.**

Complete rules

Resolve the Aftermath in this order:

1. Determine the battle result.
2. Apply effects that replace losing with withdrawal.
3. If the battle still has a winner, resolve immediate result triggers.
4. Resolve normal retreat and occupation, including replacements.
5. Resolve additional retreats and final-position effects.
6. Resolve other Aftermath effects that occur before cards leave battle.
7. Move battle cards to their destinations.
8. Resolve effects triggered by those destinations.
9. Resolve effects at the end of the Aftermath, including follow-up movement.

Normal result

Unless an effect says otherwise:

- a losing attacker returns to the position from which they entered;
- a losing defender retreats one position toward their own end;
- a winning attacker occupies the contested position; and
- a winning defender remains there.

Additional retreats resolve one position at a time. A player cannot retreat through the opponent. A player on their final Territory may retreat beyond the Gauntlet normally.

Normal card destinations

During the destination step:

- Gambits go to their owners' Graveyards;
- Tactics go to their owners' Discard Piles; and
- cards remaining in Reserve go to their owners' Discard Piles.

A card-specific instruction overrides the normal destination.

A card returned to its **source** returns to the zone from which it entered battle unless another rule gives it a different destination.

Result and destination triggers

Immediate victory triggers occur before retreat unless the effect states otherwise. Effects that require the final occupied position occur after retreat and occupation. Effects triggered by cards entering a destination occur after the cards move there.

Effects at the **end of the Aftermath** occur after normal destinations and destination-triggered effects.

8. Withdrawal and Retreat

How it works

Withdrawal is leaving a battle without determining a winner. **Retreat** is forced movement after losing. They are not the same.

When an effect causes withdrawal, the battle ends immediately. No one wins or loses, so win, loss, and retreat effects do not happen. The players still clean up their battle cards normally.

Complete rules

Voluntary movement withdrawal

During the Movement step, a player may move one position toward their own end. This is ordinary movement and does not begin a battle.

Effect-caused withdrawal from battle

Unless the effect says otherwise, withdrawal ends the battle immediately.

- Do not resolve remaining Battle effects.
- Do not roll dice.
- There is no winner or loser.
- Win, loss, and retreat triggers do not occur.
- Resolve withdrawal movement, then normal battle destinations and cleanup.

Movement:

- an attacking player returns to the position from which they entered;
- a defending player moves one position toward their own end, and the attacker occupies the contested position;
- if both withdraw, move the attacker first, then the defender.

Withdrawal during opening effects

If an effect causes one or both players to withdraw during opening effects and prevents the pending battle, use the same attacker and defender movement above. Because no battle is fought:

- no player wins, loses, or retreats;
- no battle or Aftermath triggers occur; and
- no battle-card destinations or cleanup occur.

The established attacker and defender roles are used only to determine the withdrawal movement. Resolve any remaining instructions from the effect or accepted Terms after that movement.

If a battle following refused Terms ends through withdrawal, return the Stake and do not impose or ratify the Proposal unless a specific rule says otherwise.

Retreat

Retreat is forced displacement after losing a battle. It is not movement or withdrawal.

Effects that trigger from movement or withdrawal do not trigger from retreat unless they say so.

9. Territory Control

How it works

Your token shows where you are. A Territory's orientation shows who controls it. Winning a battle lets you occupy an opposing Territory, but you normally do not capture it immediately. You must still be there at the start of your next turn.

This gives the opponent a chance to counterattack before control changes.

Complete rules

Control

The player a Territory faces controls it. Control does not require occupation.

Each player begins controlling the three Territories on their side. Control changes only through capture or an effect that explicitly changes it.

Occupation

A player normally occupies the position containing their token. During an unresolved attack, the defender remains the occupant until the result is resolved.

A player may occupy a Territory controlled by the opponent.

Capture

At the start of a player's turn, if they occupy a Territory they do not control, they capture it by rotating the Territory to face them.

A captured Territory remains under that player's control until the opponent captures it or an effect changes control.

Counterattack window

Because ordinary capture occurs at the start of the occupying player's next turn, the current controller normally receives one turn to drive the occupier away.

10. Running the Gauntlet

How it works

To win normally, push the opponent beyond their final Territory, capture that Territory, then advance beyond the column. This begins a **Last Stand battle**. Win that battle to run the Gauntlet and win the game.

The defender is harder to defeat in a Last Stand: Defender's Advantage means they win tied battle totals, and they separately add +1 to their battle total.

Complete rules

Forcing the opponent beyond the Gauntlet

When a player loses while occupying the final Territory at their end, they retreat beyond the Territory column. The winner occupies the final Territory.

The battle ends normally. The winner does not advance beyond the Gauntlet unless another rule explicitly permits it.

If the winner still occupies the final Territory at the start of their next turn, they capture it during the Capture step.

Last Stand battle

After capturing the opponent's final Territory, a player may advance beyond the Gauntlet during movement. If the opponent is there, this begins a Last Stand battle.

During a Last Stand battle:

- Defender's Advantage applies, so the defender wins tied battle totals; and
- the defender separately adds +1 to their battle total.

If the attacker wins, they have run the Gauntlet and immediately win the game.

If the defender wins, the attacker retreats to the final Territory. Play continues.

Territory-specific effects do not apply in a Last Stand battle unless they expressly apply beyond the Gauntlet.

11. Game Zones

How it works

Keep cards in clearly defined places. Your **Hand** is your permanent private set of cards. A **Reserve** exists only during one battle. The **Discard Pile** cycles back into the Draw Pile, while the **Graveyard** normally does not.

Complete rules

Draw Pile

The face-down pile formed from the Playable Deck.

Hand

The private cards held by a player. The normal Hand limit is three at end-of-turn cleanup.

Setting a Hand aside during battle does not move its cards to another zone.

Reserve

A temporary private zone formed during one battle. It is separate from the Hand. Its owner may inspect it freely.

At the end of the battle, cards remaining in Reserve normally go to the Discard Pile.

Gambit area

The area containing cards set as Gambits for the current battle. Gambits normally go to the Graveyard during the Aftermath.

Tactic area

The area containing cards chosen or played as Tactics for the current battle. Tactics normally go to the Discard Pile during the Aftermath.

Discard Pile

A face-up pile of recyclable cards. When a Draw Pile cannot complete a draw, shuffle the Discard Pile to form a new Draw Pile.

Graveyard

A face-up pile outside normal circulation. Cards there are not reshuffled unless an effect moves them.

Asset Bank

The public area containing a player's banked Assets.

Faction zones

A faction may create additional named zones such as Treasury, bound cards, Mission areas, or progress tracks. Follow the rules that create them.

12. Actions and Assets

How it works

During your Action Opportunity, play one card for its Action effect or use a faction action. Most one-time Actions go to the Discard Pile. Some cards become **Assets**, which stay in play and provide later effects.

Your Asset limit equals the number of Territories you control. When banking a new Asset at the limit, you may discard one existing Asset to make room.

Complete rules

Action effects

To play a card for its Action effect:

1. play it from Hand during an Action Opportunity;
2. satisfy all requirements and costs;
3. resolve the Action effect; and
4. put it in the Discard Pile unless it becomes an Asset or Overlay or specifies another destination.

Assets

A card is an Asset only when an effect banks it in the Asset Bank.

A player's Asset limit equals the number of Territories they control.

- A Territory occupied but not controlled does not increase the limit.
- If the limit falls below the number of Assets controlled, immediately discard Assets until within the limit.
- An inactive Asset still counts unless a rule says otherwise.

Replacing an Asset

When banking an Asset at the Asset limit, the player may discard one Asset they control to make room and bank the new Asset during the same Action Opportunity.

An effect that prevents an Asset from leaving play also prevents replacing it this way. Any consequence of the replaced Asset leaving play still occurs.

Activating and discarding Assets

Use **activate** when using an Asset's printed ability. If the effect requires the Asset to be discarded, put it in its owner's Discard Pile unless stated otherwise.

Whenever a player could play a card for its Action effect, they may instead discard one Asset they control. This uses the Action Opportunity.

13. Overlays

How it works

An Overlay sits on a Territory and temporarily replaces the exposed effect beneath it. Only the top Overlay is active, but covered Overlays remain attached.

The player who controls the Territory also controls its Overlays. Ownership does not change, so a removed Overlay still goes to its owner's destination.

Complete rules

An Overlay is a persistent card attached to a Territory. It supersedes the printed effect immediately beneath it while exposed.

Unless an effect says otherwise:

- the top exposed Overlay is active;
- lower Overlays remain attached but dormant;
- a dormant Overlay's effect and expiration timer pause;
- a printed removal condition remains active while dormant;
- when the top Overlay leaves, the next becomes active, or the Territory's effect becomes active if none remain;
- the controller of the underlying Territory controls the Overlay and makes its choices;
- Overlay control changes when Territory control changes;
- Overlay ownership does not change;
- each Overlay faces the same direction as the Territory beneath it and rotates with it;
- an Overlay is not an Asset and does not count toward the Asset limit; and
- when removed, put it in its owner's Discard Pile unless stated otherwise.

On an Overlay, **you** means its current controller unless the text identifies its owner, the player who placed it, or another player.

14. Military

How it works

The Military turns battle victories into **Command**, then spends Command on Leader-specific **Orders**. The General uses Orders to attack, reinforce, and pursue. The Commandant uses them to defend, repel, and capture.

Military has no alternate victory condition. It wins by running the Gauntlet.

Complete rules

Element	Military rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet.
Resource	Command, maximum 2.
Resource gain	The first time each turn you win a battle, gain 1 Command.
Leaders	General and Commandant.
Faction pool	12 Military card titles.
Unique card	Shock and Awe, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

A Military Deck includes:

- one Military Leader Card: **General** or **Commandant**;
- one Military Command Tracker; and
- any Military cards included in the Playable Deck.

Place the chosen Leader face up. Place the Command Tracker beneath it, fully covered, to show 0 Command. Slide the Leader upward to the 1 or 2 registration line as Command changes.

Command and Orders

How it works

The first battle you win during each turn gives you 1 Command, even when you win while defending on the opponent's turn. Spend Command only when an Order reaches its printed timing.

Complete rules

Military may have up to 2 Command.

The first time each turn the Military player wins a battle, gain 1 Command. This trigger may occur during either player's turn. Winning while already at 2 Command still counts as the first Military victory of that

turn.

Determine the winner, then gain normal Command before resolving other effects caused by that victory. Newly gained Command may pay for an Order whose timing occurs during the Aftermath.

- Use an Order only at its printed timing.
- Spend the listed Command when the Order is used unless an effect changes the cost.
- An Order cannot be used without enough Command.
- Withdrawal has no winner, so it generates no Command and cannot satisfy a victory-dependent Order.

General



Archetype: Attack, forward pressure, and tempo

Motto: *Forward. Again.*

Orders

Onward — 1 Command: During your Movement step, before a battle begins, move one additional position. This movement may start a battle.

Rally — 1 Command: Before dice are rolled in a battle you initiated, add +1 to your battle total.

Rout — 2 Command: At the end of the Aftermath of a battle you initiated and won, advance one position. This movement may start another battle.

Onward cannot be used after a battle. Rout creates a new movement sequence after the completed Aftermath.

Commandant



Archetype: Defense, counterattack, and control

Motto: *We hold. They break.*

Orders

Entrench — 1 Command: Before dice are rolled in a battle you did not initiate, add +1 to your battle total.

Repel — 1 Command: During the Aftermath of a battle you did not initiate and won, after the opponent's normal retreat, they retreat one additional position, if able.

Fortify — 2 Command: During the Aftermath of a battle you won while occupying an enemy-controlled Territory, capture that Territory.

Military-specific rules

Initiating battles

You initiated a battle when your movement or effect caused it to begin. A follow-up battle is a new battle with new Gambits, Reserves, Tactics, and once-per-battle opportunities.

Additional Tactics

Military effects may add Tactics after the normal Tactic reveal. Play such a card face up. Its effect must still be able to resolve at that timing. It does not reopen normal Tactic choice, Surveillance, Interference, or reveal windows.

Conflicting victory benefits

War Crimes and Shock and Awe may prohibit movement, capture, or Orders resulting from the same victory. Apply only combinations of effects that can legally resolve together.

15. Diplomats

How it works

Before a battle begins, a Diplomat may offer **Terms**. The Diplomat stakes Influence and presents a Proposal. The opponent may accept, preventing the battle, or refuse and fight under the Proposal's refusal effect.

Accepted or successfully imposed Proposals become Treaty Articles. Ratify five different Proposals and survive until the start of your next turn to win through the **Peace Treaty**.

Complete rules

Element	Diplomat rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete the Peace Treaty.
Resource	Influence, minimum 0 and maximum 10.
Starting value	1 Influence.
Faction procedure	Offer Terms during opening effects.
Leaders	Ambassador and Senator.
Proposal set	Nine double-sided Proposal / Treaty Article cards.
Faction pool	12 Diplomat card titles.

Components and setup

A Diplomat Deck includes:

- one Diplomat Leader Card: **Ambassador** or **Senator**;
- one Influence Tracker;
- one Diplomat Reference Card;
- nine double-sided Proposal / Treaty Article cards; and
- any Diplomat cards included in the Playable Deck.

Begin with 1 Influence. Place all nine Proposals Proposal side up.

Influence and Terms

How it works

Influence pays for negotiation and can strengthen a battle after Terms are refused. To offer Terms, choose one Proposal whose Requirement is satisfied and stake its listed Influence.

If the opponent accepts, no battle is fought. If the opponent refuses, resolve the Refused effect and continue to Gambits.

Complete rules

Influence

Diplomats begin with 1 Influence and may have up to 10.

When Influence is staked or spent, lower the tracker. Staked Influence is unavailable until the Terms resolve.

Influence gained above 10 is lost.

Offering Terms

Terms occur during opening effects after the attacker, defender, and contested position are established but before Gambits are set.

To offer Terms:

1. choose one eligible Proposal;
2. confirm its Requirement;
3. confirm enough available Influence for its Stake;
4. lower available Influence by the Stake; and
5. the opponent accepts or refuses.

A Diplomat may normally offer one Proposal for a pending battle.

Diplomat mirrors

Only one player may offer Terms for a pending battle.

1. The attacker has the first opportunity.
2. If the attacker passes, the defender may offer.
3. Once either player offers Terms, the other cannot offer Terms for that battle, even if the Proposal is refused.

Accepted Terms

When Terms are accepted:

1. no battle is fought;
2. resolve the Proposal's **Accepted** effect;
3. return the Stake;
4. if the Proposal is unratified, flip it to its Treaty Article side;
5. if newly ratified, gain Influence equal to its Stake; and
6. resolve effects that occur after acceptance.

Accepted Terms do not create a battle, winner, loser, retreat, or Aftermath.

A Stake-0 Proposal grants no Influence merely for being accepted.

Refused Terms

When Terms are refused:

1. resolve the Proposal's **Refused** effect and any refusal modifiers;
2. continue to Set Gambits;
3. before dice, the Diplomat may use Leverage; and

4. resolve the battle and its Aftermath.

Apply the result:

Result	Stake	Ratification	Normal reward
Diplomat wins	Return	If new, impose and flip	Gain 1 Influence unless stated otherwise
Diplomat loses	Lose	None	None
No winner	Return	None	None

To **impose** a Proposal is to ratify it after winning the battle caused by its refusal.

Withdrawal produces no winner. Return the Stake and do not impose the Proposal.

Leverage

Before dice are rolled in a battle following refused Terms, the Diplomat may spend any amount of available Influence. Add +1 to the Diplomat's battle total for each Influence spent.

Staked Influence cannot be spent as Leverage.

Treaty Articles and Peace Treaty

A ratified Proposal is a Treaty Article. It may be offered again for its tactical effects but cannot be ratified again and grants no normal newly-ratified Influence reward.

At the start of the Diplomat's turn, after the Capture step and before the Draw step, if five different Proposals are ratified, the Diplomat wins through the Peace Treaty.

Ambassador



Archetype: Agreement, card flow, and settlement

Motto: *Words first. War last.*

Cordiality: Once per turn, after the opponent accepts your Terms, draw one card.

Senator



Archetype: Risk management, resilience, and imposition

Motto: *Procedure endures.*

Political Capital: Once per turn, when you would lose staked Influence after losing a battle following refused Terms, you may put up to that many cards from your Hand in your Graveyard. Recover 1 staked Influence for each card put there; lose the rest.

Proposal set

De-escalation

Stake: 0

Requirement: None

Accepted: Both players withdraw. The opponent draws one card. **Refused:** Draw one card.

Orderly Withdrawal

Stake: 0

Requirement: You must be attacking.

Accepted: You withdraw. The opponent remains in or occupies the contested position, then draws one card. **Refused:** Add +1 to your battle total.

Capitulation

Stake: 0

Requirement: You must be defending.

Accepted: You withdraw. The opponent remains in or occupies the contested position, then draws one card. **Refused:** If you lose, draw two cards.

Open Channels

Stake: 1

Requirement: You must have a card in Hand.

Accepted: Both players reveal their Hands, then withdraw. The opponent draws one card. **Refused:** Reveal the opponent's Hand. When forming your Reserve, draw one additional card.

Mutual Disarmament

Stake: 1

Requirement: Both players must have a card in Hand.

Accepted: Each player discards one card from Hand. The opponent draws one card, then both players withdraw. **Refused:** You may discard one card from Hand. If you do, draw one additional card when forming your Reserve.

Prisoner Exchange

Stake: 1

Requirement: Each player must have a card in their Graveyard.

Accepted: Each player may move one card from their Graveyard to their Discard Pile. Then both players withdraw. **Refused:** If you lose, you may move one card from your Graveyard to your Discard Pile.

Rebuilding Pact

Stake: 1

Requirement: You must have a card in Hand that can be banked as an Asset.

Accepted: Each player may bank one eligible card from Hand as an Asset without using an Action Opportunity. Then both players withdraw. **Refused:** During the Aftermath of the battle, you may bank one eligible card from Hand as an Asset without using an Action Opportunity.

Ultimatum

Stake: 2

Requirement: None

Accepted: The opponent withdraws. You remain in or occupy the contested position. **Refused:** Add +1 to your battle total. If you win and newly ratify this Proposal, gain 2 Influence instead of 1.

Diplomatic Recognition

Stake: 2

Requirement: You must be defending a counterattack on a Territory you occupy that the opponent controlled immediately before you occupied it.

Accepted: Capture that Territory. The opponent withdraws, then draws two cards. **Refused:** If you win, capture that Territory during the Aftermath, but gain no Influence for imposing this Proposal.

Diplomat-specific rules

Multiple Proposals

Diplomatic Latitude may offer two eligible Proposals with the same Stake. Stake that amount once. Only the selected Proposal resolves or may become ratified.

Sanctions

Sanctions is a shared title series, not a separate card type.

Each Sanction identifies:

- the opponent whose refusal allowed it to enter play; and
- its owner.

Its ongoing effect and relief condition continue to refer to those identified players even if an Overlay changes control with its Territory.

16. Financiers

How it works

Financiers build economic power. They place cards in a **Treasury** to increase their Capital limit, gain and spend **Capital**, and buy **Deeds** connected to Territories.

Deed ownership is independent of who occupies or controls the Territory. Own the Deeds to every Territory currently in the Gauntlet to win through **Controlling Interest**.

Complete rules

Element	Financier rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or achieve Controlling Interest.
Resource	Capital, minimum 0; maximum determined by the Capital limit.
Capital limit	Territories you control plus total deckbuilding value in Treasury.
Income	After the Capture step, gain 1 Capital per Deed you own.
Leaders	Banker and Executive.
Faction pool	12 Financier card titles.
Unique card	Corner the Market, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

A Financier Deck includes:

- one Financier Leader Card: **Banker** or **Executive**;
- one Financier Reference Card;
- one public Capital Ledger;
- eight identical full-size Deed Cards in a shared supply; and
- any Financier cards included in the Playable Deck.

Begin with 0 Capital and an empty Treasury. Place Deed Cards in the shared unowned supply.

Capital, Treasury, and Deeds

How it works

Capital is public and pays for Deeds, Subsidize, and card effects. Your Capital limit rises when you control Territories or place valuable cards in Treasury. You may temporarily exceed the limit, but excess Capital is lost at the end of each turn.

During an Action Opportunity after movement, you may place a card in Treasury, buy a Deed, or Play the Market instead of playing an Action card.

Complete rules

Capital and Capital Ledger

Capital cannot fall below 0. Record every gain, spend, loss, and end-turn reduction on the public Capital Ledger, including the new running Balance.

Capital limit = Territories you control + total deckbuilding value of cards in your Treasury

Capital may exceed the limit temporarily. At the end of every turn, including an opponent's turn, reduce your Capital to the current limit if necessary.

Treasury

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, place one card from your Hand face up in your Treasury.

- Treasury cards are outside normal card zones.
- They cannot be played or affected unless a rule specifically refers to Treasury.
- Each increases the Capital limit by its deckbuilding value.
- Treasury is not the Asset Bank and uses no Asset capacity.
- A card leaving Treasury immediately stops contributing to the limit.
- Treasury cards do not generate Capital by themselves.

Deeds

Each Territory currently in the Gauntlet has one Deed. A Deed is unowned or owned by a Financier.

When buying an unowned Deed, take a Deed Card from the supply and place it beside that Territory on the owner's side. In a Financier mirror, placement identifies ownership.

When buying out an opposing Financier's Deed, move its Deed Card to the buyer's side. When a Deed becomes unowned, return its card to the supply.

Deed ownership is independent of Territory occupation and control. Changing Territory control does not transfer its Deed. A Deed is not an Asset or Overlay.

Buying and buying out Deeds

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, buy or buy out one Deed by paying its full cost.

Effects that permit several purchases resolve each purchase completely before recalculating the next cost.

Deed cost = min(Deeds you own + 1, 6) + position modifier + buyout premium

Minimum cost is 1 Capital.

Territory state from buyer's perspective	Modifier
You control it	-1
You occupy it but do not control it	0
You neither control nor occupy it	+1

For an unowned Deed, buyout premium is 0.

For a Deed owned by an opposing Financier:

$$\text{Buyout premium} = \min(\text{Deeds the opposing owner owns}, 6)$$

Income

After the Capture step at the start of your turn, gain 1 Capital for each Deed you own. Income may temporarily exceed the Capital limit.

Controlling Interest

When you own the Deeds to every Territory currently in the Gauntlet, immediately win through

Controlling Interest.

A Territory added to the Gauntlet has a normal Deed and expands the required portfolio.

Play the Market

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, discard one card from Hand and roll one die:

Roll	Result
1	Put the card in your Graveyard; gain 0 Capital.
2–3	Gain 1 Capital.
4–5	Gain Capital equal to the card's deckbuilding value.
6	Gain Capital equal to twice the card's deckbuilding value.

Subsidize

Before dice are rolled in a battle involving you, spend Capital to add to your battle total.

Bonus	Total cost
+1	1 Capital
+2	3 Capital
+3	6 Capital
+4	10 Capital

The progression continues without a fixed maximum. Each additional +1 costs one more Capital than the previous increment. Capital spent through Subsidize is lost regardless of the result.

An additional Action Opportunity permits one additional qualifying action at its legal timing. During an after-movement opportunity this may include Treasury, a Deed purchase, Play the Market, or Hostile Takeover. It does not grant movement.

Banker



Archetype: Collateral, planned purchases, and flexible financing

Motto: *Credit closes the distance.*

Line of Credit: The first time on your turn that you would buy or buy out a Deed, you may use one card from your Hand or Treasury as collateral. - It contributes payment equal to its deckbuilding value. - It cannot contribute more than half the purchase cost, rounded down. - Pay the remaining cost with Capital. - Put the collateral in your Discard Pile after the purchase. - Unused collateral value is lost. - Line of Credit applies only to Deed purchases and buyouts.

Executive



Archetype: Offensive acquisition, occupation, and immediate control

Motto: *Take the ground. Close the deal.*

Hostile Takeover: During an Action Opportunity after movement, if you won a battle as the attacker this turn and now occupy that enemy Territory, you may buy or buy out its Deed instead of playing a card for its Action effect. Treat the Territory as occupied but not controlled for the cost calculation. If the purchase succeeds, immediately take control of that Territory.

Financier-specific rules

Collateral

Collateral is not a separate zone. Place the collateral beneath the card or effect using it so its source and value remain visible.

- Line of Credit collateral goes to the Discard Pile after purchase.
- Margin Loan collateral returns only after repayment or a qualifying battle victory; default puts both cards in the Graveyard.
- Leveraged Buyout collateral goes to the Graveyard after purchase or instead of its normal battle destination.
- Collateral contributes payment value but does not become Capital unless stated.
- Unused collateral value is lost.

Added Territories

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A Territory added to the Gauntlet:

- has a Deed;
- counts toward Capital and Asset limits when controlled;
- generates income when its Deed is owned;
- expands Controlling Interest; and
- uses the normal capped cost formulas.

Self-tracking cards

- Speculation remains face up beside its selected Territory and is neither an Asset nor Overlay.
- Capital Gains is placed beneath its selected Treasury card.
- Margin Loan holds its collateral beneath it.

Tariffs and Asset replacement

You cannot bank Tariffs while another copy you control is banked. During the turn Tariffs is banked, you cannot voluntarily cause it to leave play, including replacing it to make room for another Asset.

Underwriting and Property Dues may be replaced normally. Replacing Margin Loan before resolution causes default.

17. Intelligence

How it works

Intelligence pursues hidden **Missions**, earns **Intel**, and builds **Operation Progress**. Intel lets the faction reveal an opponent's hidden battle choice through **Surveillance** and remove it through **Interference**.

Complete enough Missions to make a **Special Operation** ready, satisfy its hidden requirement, and pay its Intel cost to win.

Complete rules

Element	Intelligence rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete a Special Operation.
Tracked values	Intel and Operation Progress; both begin at 0.
Mission reward	1 Operation Progress and Intel equal to the Mission card's value.
Battle tools	Surveillance and Interference.
Leaders	Ranger and Spymaster.
Unique card	Sleeper Network, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

An Intelligence Deck includes:

- one Intelligence Leader Card: **Ranger** or **Spymaster**;
- one Mission Reference Card;
- one Operations Reference Card;
- one Intel Tracker;
- one Operation Progress Tracker; and
- any Intelligence cards included in the Playable Deck.

Both values begin at 0 and have no maximum. Only an Intelligence card with a printed **Mission** requirement may become an Active Mission or Special Operation.

Intel, Missions, and Special Operations

How it works

During an Action Opportunity after movement, place an eligible card face down as your Active Mission instead of playing an Action. Once you have satisfied its requirement on a later turn, use another after-movement Action Opportunity to reveal and complete it.

A completed Mission gives 1 Operation Progress and Intel equal to the card's deckbuilding value. When Operation Progress exceeds the number of Territories the opponent controls, you may begin a Special Operation.

Complete rules

Intel

Intel begins at 0, cannot fall below 0, and has no maximum. Spend it for Surveillance, Interference, Fieldcraft, Mission abortion, Special Operation completion, and card effects.

Operation Progress

Operation Progress begins at 0 and is not normally spent. Each completed normal Mission adds 1, regardless of card value.

Starting a Mission

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, place one eligible Intelligence card from your Hand face down near your Leader as your **Active Mission**.

- You may inspect it at any time.
- You may have only one Active Mission.
- You cannot have an Active Mission and Special Operation simultaneously.
- It cannot complete during the turn it begins.
- Its printed requirement counts only while it is the Active Mission.
- Starting it is not playing the card for a printed effect.

Completing a Mission

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, reveal and complete the Active Mission if its requirement has been satisfied.

1. Gain 1 Operation Progress.
2. Gain Intel equal to its deckbuilding value.
3. Put it in your Discard Pile.

Satisfying the requirement does not complete it automatically.

Aborting and failing

During an Action Opportunity after movement, reveal the Active Mission and spend Intel equal to its value to abort it. Put it in the Discard Pile. Aborting is not failure.

A Mission fails only when a rule, effect, or continuing requirement causes failure. Reveal it and put it in the Graveyard.

Starting a Special Operation

You may start a Special Operation only when:

- your Operation Progress exceeds the number of Territories the opponent controls;
- you have no Active Mission or Special Operation; and
- you have an eligible Intelligence card in Hand.

During an Action Opportunity after movement, place that card face down as your Special Operation.

A Special Operation uses the printed Mission requirement but is not a normal Mission. It grants no Mission reward and does not trigger normal-Mission effects.

Readiness and completion

The Special Operation remains ready only while Operation Progress exceeds the number of Territories the opponent controls. If readiness is lost, it immediately fails and goes to the Graveyard.

During an Action Opportunity after movement, if its requirement is satisfied and readiness remains valid, reveal it and pay:

Territories currently in the Gauntlet – Special Operation card's deckbuilding value

Minimum payment is 1 Intel. If paid, immediately win through Special Operation.

Surveillance and Interference

How it works

Intelligence gets two separate chances to use Surveillance in each battle: one against an opposing Gambit and one against opposing Tactics. Spend 1 Intel for each face-down card revealed.

Immediately after revealing a card, spend 2 more Intel to interfere. The card returns to its source, and the opponent may replace it from that same source or pass.

Complete rules

Gambit Surveillance

Once per battle, after the opponent sets a face-down Gambit, spend 1 Intel to reveal it.

After you resolve any Interference against that revealed Gambit and the opponent makes any replacement, you may revise your own Gambit choice if you have already made one. Revision does not create another Surveillance or Interference opportunity.

Tactic Surveillance

Once per battle, after the opponent chooses one or more face-down Tactics, spend 1 Intel for each opposing Tactic you reveal.

After you resolve any Interference against those revealed Tactics and the opponent makes replacements, you may revise your own Tactic choices if you have already made them. Revision does not create another Surveillance or Interference opportunity.

The Gambit and Tactic opportunities are independent. Using one does not consume the other.

Interference after Surveillance

Immediately after revealing a card through Surveillance, spend 2 additional Intel per revealed card you remove.

- A removed Gambit returns to its owner's Hand.
- A removed Tactic returns to its owner's Reserve.

- The owner may choose one eligible replacement from the same source or pass.
- A replacement is placed face down unless the effect says otherwise.
- The replacement creates no new Surveillance, Interference, reveal, or response opportunity.

If an effect prevents Surveillance or Interference, the Intel remains spent and the relevant once-per-battle opportunity is still used.

Direct Interference

When an opposing effect sets or chooses a card face up and the normal Surveillance reveal is unnecessary, Intelligence may spend 2 Intel to Interfere with that card directly at the same response timing. This does not use Surveillance but does use the relevant stage's Interference opportunity.

Intelligence mirrors

At each choice stage:

1. the first player makes the relevant choice;
2. the second player may use Surveillance and Interference, then makes their choice;
3. the first player may use Surveillance and Interference, then revise their own choice if allowed; and
4. the stage closes.

Ranger



Archetype: Territory effects, reconnaissance, and field operations

Motto: *Know the land before the battle begins.*

Fieldcraft: Once per turn, when a printed Territory effect would affect you, your movement, or a battle involving you, you may spend 1 Intel to ignore that Territory effect until the end of the turn.

Fieldcraft does not alter Territory control, occupation, capture, Defender's Advantage, Last Stand bonuses, or limits calculated from Territories.

Spymaster



Archetype: Mission tempo and operational coordination

Motto: *Information never rests. Momentum is the weapon.*

Mission Control: Once per turn, after completing a normal Mission, you may immediately start another eligible Mission from your Hand without using an Action Opportunity. It cannot complete that turn. Mission Control cannot start a Special Operation.

Intelligence-specific rules

Counterintelligence

When Counterintelligence prevents an opposing effect from revealing a Hand, Reserve, face-down battle card, or Territory, it prevents the entire opposing revealing effect, not only the information portion. Rules-mandated reveals are unaffected.

Watchtower

When the controller of Watchtower defends there, the attacker sets their Gambit face up or passes; the defender sets normally. Because the attacker's Gambit was never face down, Counterintelligence does not prevent the reveal. Intelligence may use Direct Interference for 2 Intel.

18. Mystics

How it works

Mystics sacrifice, bind, exchange, and recover cards while completing three public **Rites**. The first completed Rite unlocks **Invocation**, the second unlocks **Transmutation**, and the third unlocks **Convergence** and the ability to begin the **Ritual of Ascendence**.

To win through Ritual, bind three cards from three different zones, initiate a battle while they remain bound, and win that battle.

Complete rules

Element	Mystics rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete the Ritual of Ascendence.
Resource	None.
Trait	All twelve Mystics cards have the Arcane trait.
Progression	First Rite: Invocation; second: Transmutation; third: Convergence and Ritual.
Leaders	Alchemist and Spirit Walker.
Unique card	Necromancy, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

A Mystics Deck includes:

- one Mystics Leader Card: **Alchemist** or **Spirit Walker**;
- one Mystics Reference Card;
- three double-sided Rite cards: **Rite of Echoes**, **Rite of Blood**, and **Rite of Crossing**; and
- any Mystics cards included in the Playable Deck.

Place all three Rite cards incomplete side up. Mystics use no resource tracker.

Rites and progression

How it works

During an Action Opportunity after movement, pay a Rite's beginning cost to begin it. You may have only one begun but incomplete Rite at a time, and a Rite cannot complete on the turn it begins.

Once its condition is met on a later turn, complete it and unlock the next faction ability. Completed Rites remain complete.

Complete rules

Beginning a Rite

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, begin one incomplete Rite by paying its beginning cost.

- You may have only one begun but incomplete Rite.
- You may begin any uncompleted Rite; there is no required order.
- A Rite cannot complete during the turn it begins.
- Only one Rite may be completed per turn.
- If interrupted, it resets and paid costs are not returned unless stated.

Progression

- Complete the first Rite to unlock **Invocation**.
- Complete the second Rite to unlock **Transmutation**.
- Complete the third Rite to unlock **Convergence** and permission to begin the **Ritual of Ascendancy**.

Bound cards

A card bound to a Rite, Ritual, or another card is outside normal zones.

- A face-up bound card is public.
- A face-down bound card may be inspected only by its owner.
- A bound card cannot be played, moved, or affected except as instructed by the effect to which it is bound.
- If the binding effect ends and gives no destination, put the bound card in its owner's Graveyard.

Invocation

Once per turn, when an Arcane card you play, set, or choose resolves its Action, Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect, you may move one card from your Graveyard to your Discard Pile.

A copied effect does not trigger Invocation unless the Arcane card itself resolves another printed effect through being played, set, or chosen again.

Transmutation

Once per turn, before dice are rolled in a battle involving you, you may put one card from your Hand in your Graveyard. Add its deckbuilding value to your battle total.

The card is not played and none of its printed effects resolve. Supplemental components cannot be used.

The three Rites

Rite of Echoes

Beginning cost: Bind one chosen card from your Graveyard face up beneath this Rite. Then bind one card from your Hand face down beneath it whose title matches at least one other card in your Playable Deck.

Completion: On a later turn, complete this Rite when another card with the bound Hand card's title resolves its Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect during a battle.

On completion:

- move the selected Graveyard card to your Discard Pile;
- put the bound Hand card in your Graveyard;
- resolve the completing card normally; and
- flip Rite of Echoes to its completed side.

If you lose a battle before completion, put both bound cards in your Graveyard and reset the Rite.

Rite of Blood

Beginning cost: Put one card from your Hand in your Graveyard.

Completion: On a later turn, complete this Rite when you win a battle without setting a Gambit or choosing a Tactic.

Using Transmutation, an Asset, Overlay, Territory, Leader ability, or card from another source does not by itself prevent completion.

If you lose a battle before completion, reset the Rite.

Rite of Crossing

You may begin this Rite only during an Action Opportunity after movement after winning a battle that caused you to occupy a Territory the opponent controlled immediately before that battle.

Beginning cost: Put one Arcane card from your Hand in your Graveyard. If you have none, reveal your Hand and move one Arcane card from your Discard Pile to your Graveyard instead.

Completion: At the start of your next turn, after the Capture step, complete this Rite if you still occupy or control that Territory. Otherwise, the Rite is interrupted and resets.

Ritual of Ascendancy and Convergence

How it works

After completing all three Rites, use an Action Opportunity after movement to bind one Arcane card from your Hand, one from your Discard Pile, and one from your Graveyard. This begins the Ritual.

Initiate a battle while all three remain bound. Convergence adds +1 for each Ritual card. Win that battle to win the game. Lose any battle before completion and the Ritual is interrupted.

Complete rules

Beginning the Ritual

After completing all three Rites, during an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, bind:

- one Arcane card from your Hand;
- one Arcane card from your Discard Pile; and
- one Arcane card from your Graveyard.

This begins the Ritual of Ascendance.

Convergence

While the Ritual is underway, during a battle you initiated, add +1 to your battle total for each card bound to the Ritual.

With all three cards bound, Convergence normally gives +3.

Completion

Initiate a battle while all three Ritual cards remain bound. If you win that battle, complete the Ritual and immediately win the game.

The Mystic must initiate the final battle.

Interruption

If you lose any battle before Ritual completion, the Ritual is interrupted. Put all three Ritual-bound cards in your Graveyard.

Completed Rites remain complete. You may begin the Ritual again later.

Withdrawal neither completes nor interrupts the Ritual because it has no winner or loser.

Alchemist



Archetype: Sacrifice sequencing and card conversion

Motto: *Nothing is fixed. Everything can be transformed.*

Materia Prima: The first time on your turn that you put a card from your Hand in your Graveyard as part of a Rite, Transmutation, or an Arcane card effect, draw one card. If this occurs during a battle, draw after the Aftermath of the battle.

A Gambit entering the Graveyard during normal destinations does not trigger Materia Prima merely because it came from Hand.

Spirit Walker



Archetype: Rite endurance and protective sacrifice

Motto: *The spirits remember what the living abandon.*

Guardians of the Circle: The first time on your turn that you lose a battle and a begun Rite would be interrupted, you may put one Arcane card from your Hand in your Graveyard. If you do, that Rite is not interrupted.

Guardians of the Circle cannot preserve a continuing position requirement and does not protect the Ritual of Ascendance.

Mystics-specific rules

Arcane trait

Arcane is a trait, not faction allegiance. Mystics cards are Arcane, and cards from other pools may also have the trait.

Entering the Graveyard

A card enters the Graveyard before an effect such as Grave Ward moves it elsewhere. An entry trigger still resolves even if the card immediately leaves.

Exchange

To exchange two cards, move each simultaneously to the other's previous zone. Both must remain eligible and present. If either cannot move, no exchange occurs.

Repeating Battle effects

Witchcraft and similar effects follow the shared copied-effect rules. A repeat effect cannot choose another repeat or card-adding effect unless it expressly permits one additional layer.

19. Inquisition

How it works

The Inquisition gains **Conviction** when opposing cards are permanently lost after battles. It also sends opposing Tactics to the Graveyard through **Condemnation** and gains additional Conviction when the opponent plays or reveals Arcane cards through **Blasphemy**.

Spend Conviction on **Purges** that remove cards and Assets. If the opponent eventually cannot make their normal start-of-turn draw because both their Draw Pile and Discard Pile are empty, win through **Purification**.

Complete rules

Element	Inquisition rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or achieve Purification.
Resource	Conviction, maximum 4.
Normal gain	First time each turn opposing cards enter the Graveyard during the Aftermath of a battle involving you.
Doctrine	Condemnation and Blasphemy.
Faction action	Purge.
Leaders	Grand Inquisitor and Witch Hunter.
Faction pool	12 Inquisition card titles.
Arcane card	Heresy.

Components and setup

An Inquisition Deck includes:

- one Inquisition Leader Card: **Grand Inquisitor** or **Witch Hunter**;
- one Inquisition Doctrine Reference Card;
- one Purge Reference Card;
- one Conviction Tracker; and
- any Inquisition cards included in the Playable Deck.

Begin with 0 Conviction. Slide the Leader over the tracker to show 0–4.

Conviction, doctrine, Purge, and Purification

How it works

The first time opposing cards enter the Graveyard during the Aftermath of a battle involving you each turn, gain 1 Conviction. Opposing Tactics go there instead of the Discard Pile, making battle choices more costly against the Inquisition.

During an Action Opportunity, spend Conviction on one Purge instead of playing an Action card.

Complete rules

Conviction

Conviction: Maximum 4. The first time each turn one or more opposing cards enter the Graveyard during the Aftermath of a battle involving you, gain 1 Conviction.

- This may occur during either player's turn.
- Several qualifying cards from the same battle still produce only 1 normal gain.
- Winning is not required.
- Conviction above 4 is lost.

Condemnation

Condemnation: During the Aftermath of battles involving you, opposing Tactics go to their owner's Graveyard instead of their Discard Pile.

Opposing Gambits already go to the Graveyard normally. Cards remaining in the opponent's Reserve are discarded normally.

Blasphemy

Blasphemy: Whenever an opponent plays a card with the Arcane trait for its Action effect, or an Arcane Gambit or Tactic they control is revealed, gain 1 Conviction.

This gain is outside the normal once-per-turn Conviction gain but cannot exceed 4. An Arcane card resolved only through a copied effect is not played or revealed as a Gambit or Tactic and does not trigger Blasphemy unless the effect says otherwise. Arcane is a trait, not faction allegiance.

Purge

During an Action Opportunity, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, spend Conviction to perform one Purge:

Cost	Purge
1	Choose one: put the top card of the opponent's Discard Pile in their Graveyard; or choose up to two cards there with combined value 2 or less and put them in their Graveyard.
2	Choose one opposing Asset and put it in its owner's Graveyard.
3	The opponent chooses one card from their Hand and puts it in their Graveyard.
4	Reveal the opponent's Hand. Choose one card and put it in their Graveyard.

A Purge uses the Action Opportunity but is not playing a card. Final Judgment may permit a Purge outside an Action Opportunity.

Purification

At the beginning of the opponent's turn, after their normal start-of-turn draw attempt, if they draw no cards because both their Draw Pile and Discard Pile are empty, immediately win through **Purification**.

A failed Reserve draw or effect-generated draw does not trigger Purification.

Grand Inquisitor



Archetype: Judgment, Purge, and permanent removal

Motto: *We judge. We purge.*

Final Judgment: Once per turn, during the Aftermath of a battle you won, after cards follow their destinations, you may immediately Purge without using an Action Opportunity. Reduce that Purge's Conviction cost by 1, to a minimum of 1.

The normal Conviction gain from that battle may resolve before Final Judgment.

Witch Hunter



Archetype: Defense, retaliation, and pursuit

Motto: *You ran. I followed.*

Relentless Pursuit: Once per turn, at the end of the Aftermath of a battle an opponent initiated against you and lost, you may spend 2 Conviction. End their turn, then move one position toward their end of the Gauntlet. This movement may start a battle; you are the attacker. No Action Opportunity occurs before that battle.

Withdrawal has no loser, so neither Leader ability triggers from it.

Inquisition-specific rules

Discard Pile order

The top card is the most recently placed card unless a rule changes the order. Choosing cards from a Discard Pile does not reorder the rest.

Combined deckbuilding value

When an effect allows several cards within a combined value limit, add their printed values. The total cannot exceed the limit.

No Martyrs

No Martyrs prevents the losing opponent from benefiting from effects they control that trigger from that loss or resulting retreat. It does not prevent harmful consequences, the retreat itself, or effects controlled by another player.

Heresy and copied effects

Heresy follows the shared copied-effect rule but retains permission for one additional copied-effect layer. That additional effect cannot create another layer. The selected Graveyard card remains there.

Quick Battle Reference

1. Opening effects.
2. Attacker sets a Gambit or passes.
3. Defender sets a Gambit or passes.
4. Set Hands aside; each player draws three to form a Reserve.
5. Reveal and resolve Gambits.
6. Attacker chooses a Tactic or passes.
7. Defender chooses a Tactic or passes.
8. Reveal and resolve Tactics.
9. Resolve pre-dice effects, roll, and determine the winner.
10. Resolve the Aftermath.
11. Gambits go to Graveyards; Tactics and remaining Reserve cards go to Discard Piles.

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